Stats honestly mean very little to me, in the sense that I don't play for them at all. I've never batted in an attempt to maintain or improve my average. Yes, the stats don't lie, and my Test and ODI averages (41.95 and 36.13 as I write) are not bad, but everybody's got periods when they're more consistent than at other times. Those stats don't tell of the times – particularly between 2002 and 2005 – when I was averaging as much as the best in the business.

No, what I have wanted to do more than anything else is give people their money's worth. I was born to entertain, and that was always going to be the way I was going to approach my game. If you ask Sir Viv Richards if he would have liked to have scored more runs, he will probably say yes. But whether he got 20 or 40 centuries was not really going to make all that much difference. What really mattered was the way in which he played the game, for which cricket fans still revere him. I mean, no one says that maybe Sir Viv's average could've been a bit higher or he could've scored a few more 100s!

Instead, it was all about how batsmen like him played the game. Whether it is four-day domestic stuff, Test matches or limited-overs internationals, it's all about entertaining the people who have come to watch. I'll give you an example of what I mean: take Sachin Tendulkar's 200 against us in the second ODI in Gwalior, India, early in 2010. He played a brilliant innings – 200 off 147 balls, and the first-ever double ton in an ODI. I was watching his innings on the field that day, and he slowed down in the final four or five overs to make sure he got the record.

Now, I take nothing away from Sachin – the guy is a total genius, probably the best ever – but I would've approached those final overs totally differently. Maybe I would've gone out within touching distance of the record – like I did in the 438 game, when I had plenty of time to get a double ton – but if I was in Sachin's position, I would've really gone balls-to-the-wall to try to see if I could get my team close to 480 or 500 runs, rather than focus on my own double century.

Of course it crossed my mind that I might get 200 in the 438 game, but I just said to myself, 'If I get it, I get it; if I don't, so be it.' On that particular day, if I could've hit every ball for six, I would have done so. It's pretty much exactly what I tried to do! I went out after hitting two sixes and then going for a third. I dragged the ball and got caught. I wasn't going to die wondering.